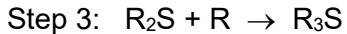
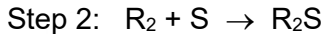


10 Consider the following reaction.



The mechanism involves the following steps:



The overall kinetics is found to be third order. Based on the information, which is the slow step in the mechanism?

A Step 1

B Step 2

C Step 3

D None of the above